

COURSE NOTES

Applied Abstract Algebra Quiver Theory

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TA:

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Chapter 1

Lecture 1

Course Information

Main topic: Representation theory of quivers.

Office hours: Mon: 12:30-14:30. Office 218, Taizhou Building.

Main book: *Ralf Schiffler, Quiver Representations*

References:

- *Assem, Simson, Skowroński, Elements of the Representation Theory of Associative Algebras, Vol. 1: Techniques of Representation Theory*, Cambridge University Press.
- *Ibrahim Assem, Basic Representation Theory of Algebras.*
- *Michel Brion, Representations of Quivers.*
- *Henning Krause, Representations of Quivers via Reflection Functor.*
- *W. Crawley-Boevey, Lectures on Representations of Quivers.*
- *Ralf Schiffler, Quiver Representations.*
- *Alexander Kirillov Jr., Quiver Representations and Quiver Varieties*, Graduate Studies in Mathematics, American Mathematical Society, 2016.

Grading:

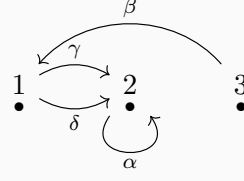
- Midterm: 30%
- Attendance: 10%
- Homework: 20%
- Final: 40%

Midterm will be on April 13th, Monday, 2026 (the 8th week).

1.1 Quivers

Definition 1.1.1. A quiver Q is a quadruple (Q_0, Q_1, s, t) , where Q_0 is a set of vertices, Q_1 is a set of arrows, and $s, t : Q_1 \rightarrow Q_0$ are two maps. For any arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$, $s(\alpha)$ is called the source of α and $t(\alpha)$ is called the target of α . For example, if $\alpha : 1 \rightarrow 2$, then $s(\alpha) = 1$ and $t(\alpha) = 2$.

Example 1.1.2. Let $Q_0 = \{1, 2, 3\}$, $Q_1 = \{\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta\}$. We have $s(\alpha) = 2, t(\alpha) = 2$; $s(\beta) = 3, t(\beta) = 1$; $s(\gamma) = s(\delta) = 1, t(\gamma) = t(\delta) = 2$.

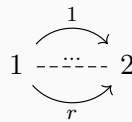


Let path $\xi = \alpha\gamma\beta$, then we have $s(\xi) = s(\beta) = 3$ and $t(\xi) = t(\alpha) = 2$.

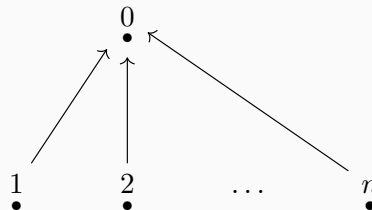
Example 1.1.3. *Jordan quiver.* The Jordan quiver consists of a single vertex and a single arrow starting and ending at this vertex. Formally, $Q_0 = \{1\}$ and $Q_1 = \{\alpha\}$ with $s(\alpha) = t(\alpha) = 1$. It is called the Jordan quiver because its representations correspond to vector spaces equipped with a linear endomorphism. The classification of such representations up to isomorphism is equivalent to the classification of square matrices up to similarity, which is given by the Jordan normal form theorem (over an algebraically closed field).



Example 1.1.4. *r-Kronecker quiver.* The r-Kronecker quiver has two vertices, say 1 and 2, and r arrows $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r$ from 1 to 2. Thus $Q_0 = \{1, 2\}$, $Q_1 = \{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r\}$, with $s(\alpha_i) = 1$ and $t(\alpha_i) = 2$ for all $i = 1, \dots, r$. It is named after Leopold Kronecker. In the case $r = 2$, the representations correspond to pairs of linear maps between two vector spaces, which can be represented by matrix pencils. Kronecker solved the classification problem for these pencils.



Example 1.1.5. *n-subspace quiver.* The n-subspace quiver consists of $n + 1$ vertices $\{0, 1, \dots, n\}$ and n arrows $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ such that $s(\alpha_i) = i$ and $t(\alpha_i) = 0$ for all $i = 1, \dots, n$. It is called the n-subspace quiver because its representations are related to configurations of subspaces. If the linear maps associated with the arrows are injective, a representation corresponds to a collection of n subspaces of the vector space associated with the central vertex.



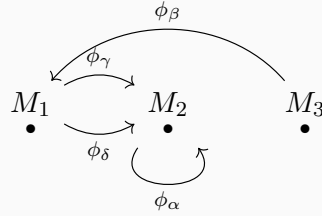
Definition 1.1.6. *Finite quivers.* A quiver $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$ is called finite if both the set of vertices Q_0 and the set of arrows Q_1 are finite sets.

For the base field we assume $k = \bar{k}$. Usually we take $k = \mathbb{C}$.

1.2 Representations

Definition 1.2.1. A representation M of a quiver Q consists of a vector space M_i for each vertex $i \in Q_0$ and a linear map $\phi_\alpha : M_{s(\alpha)} \rightarrow M_{t(\alpha)}$ for each arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$. We denote this representation by $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$.

Example 1.2.2. For example 1:



Then $M = (M_1, M_2, M_3, \phi_\gamma, \phi_\delta, \phi_\alpha, \phi_\beta)$ is a representation of the quiver Q .

Definition 1.2.3. A representation M is called **finite dimensional** if $\dim M_i < \infty$ for all $i \in Q_0$. The tuple $\dim M = \{\dim M_i\}_{i \in Q_0}$ is called the **dimension vector** of M . An element $m \in M$ is a tuple $\{m_i\}_{i \in Q_0}$ where $m_i \in M_i$ for each $i \in Q_0$.

Example 1.2.4. 1-Kronecker quiver:

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Take k to be a field. Some representations of this quiver are:

$$M : k \xrightarrow{1} k \quad M' : k \xrightarrow{0} k \quad M'' : k \xrightarrow{0} 0$$

Another example is

$$\widetilde{M} : k^2 \xrightarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}} k^3 .$$

For $v = (1, 0) \in k^2$, we have

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} .$$

The dimension vectors are $\underline{\dim}M = (1, 1)$, $\underline{\dim}M' = (1, 1)$, $\underline{\dim}M'' = (1, 0)$ and $\underline{\dim}\widetilde{M} = (2, 3)$.

1.3 Morphisms and the Category $\text{Rep } Q$

Definition 1.3.1 (A Morphism between two representations of Q). Let $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ be two representations of Q . A morphism $f : M \rightarrow N$ is a collection of linear maps $f_i : M_i \rightarrow N_i$ such that for every $\phi_\alpha : M_i \rightarrow M_j$, $\alpha \in Q_1$ the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M_i & \xrightarrow{\phi_\alpha} & M_j \\ f_i \downarrow & & \downarrow f_j \\ N_i & \xrightarrow{\psi_\alpha} & N_j \end{array}$$

A morphism $f = (f_i)_{i \in Q_0} : M \rightarrow N$ is called an **isomorphism of representations** if each f_i is an isomorphism. The class of all representations that are isomorphic to a given representation M is called the **isomorphism class** of M .

Example 1.3.2. In example of 1-Kronecker quiver, let $f : M \rightarrow M''$, $f_1 : k \rightarrow k$ such that $f_1(1) = a$, and $f_2 : k \rightarrow 0$ is the zero map. We can check that f is a morphism. Only need to check the commutativity of the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & k & \xrightarrow{1} & k & \\ f_1 & a \downarrow & & \downarrow 0 & f_2 \\ & k & \xrightarrow{0} & 0 & \end{array}$$

Now we establish $g : M'' \rightarrow M$. If g is a morphism, then we have $g_1 : k \rightarrow k$ such that $g_1(1) = b$, and $g_2 : 0 \rightarrow k$ is the zero map. To make the target diagram commute it forces $g_1 = 0$. Hence there are only 0 morphism from M'' to M .

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & k & \xrightarrow{0} & 0 & \\ g_1 & b \downarrow & & \downarrow 0 & g_2 \\ & k & \xrightarrow{1} & k & \end{array}$$

$$1 \circ g_1 = 0 \Rightarrow g_1 = 0$$

Recall the definition of category:

Definition 1.3.3. A category $\mathcal{C}$ consists of the following data:

- A class of objects, denoted by $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$.
- For any pair of objects $X, Y \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, a set of morphisms from X to Y , denoted by $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$. If $f \in \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$, we write $f : X \rightarrow Y$.

- For any three objects $X, Y, Z \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, a composition map:

$$\circ : \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(Y, Z) \times \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Z), \quad (g, f) \mapsto g \circ f.$$

These data must satisfy the following axioms:

1. **Associativity:** For any morphisms $f : X \rightarrow Y$, $g : Y \rightarrow Z$, and $h : Z \rightarrow W$, we have

$$h \circ (g \circ f) = (h \circ g) \circ f.$$

2. **Identity:** For every object $X \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, there exists an identity morphism $\text{id}_X \in \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, X)$ such that for any $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Z \rightarrow X$,

$$f \circ \text{id}_X = f \quad \text{and} \quad \text{id}_X \circ g = g.$$

Denote $\text{Rep}Q$ the category of representations of Q . Then $\text{Ob}(\text{Rep}Q)$ is the class of representations of Q : $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)$, and $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep}Q}$ is the class of morphisms $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep}Q}(M, N)$ from M to N .

Let $M, N \in \text{Ob}(\text{Rep}Q)$. Then $\text{Hom}(M, N) := \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep}Q}(M, N)$ is a vector space over k with operations defined component-wise: for $f, g \in \text{Hom}(M, N)$ and $\lambda \in k$, let $(f + g)_i = f_i + g_i$ and $(\lambda f)_i = \lambda f_i$ for all $i \in Q_0$.

Verification: Let $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. Since f, g are morphisms, for any arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$, we have $\psi_\alpha f_i = f_j \phi_\alpha$ and $\psi_\alpha g_i = g_j \phi_\alpha$.

1. Addition:

$$\psi_\alpha(f + g)_i = \psi_\alpha(f_i + g_i) = \psi_\alpha f_i + \psi_\alpha g_i = f_j \phi_\alpha + g_j \phi_\alpha = (f_j + g_j) \phi_\alpha = (f + g)_j \phi_\alpha.$$

Thus $f + g \in \text{Hom}(M, N)$.

2. Scalar Multiplication:

$$\psi_\alpha(\lambda f)_i = \psi_\alpha(\lambda f_i) = \lambda(\psi_\alpha f_i) = \lambda(f_j \phi_\alpha) = (\lambda f_j) \phi_\alpha = (\lambda f)_j \phi_\alpha.$$

Thus $\lambda f \in \text{Hom}(M, N)$.

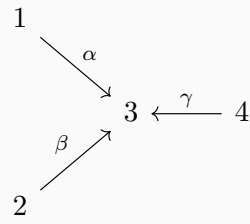
The zero morphism $0 = (0)_{i \in Q_0}$ clearly satisfies the commutativity condition. The vector space axioms follow from the structure of linear maps between vector spaces.

Example 1.3.4. Consider

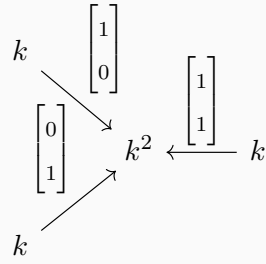
$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

$$\text{Hom}(M, M'') = \{(a, 0) | a \in k\} \simeq k. \quad \text{Hom}(M'', M) = \{0\}.$$

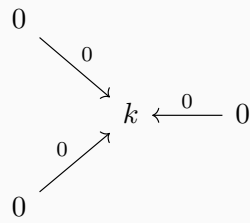
Example 1.3.5. Let Q be a quiver:



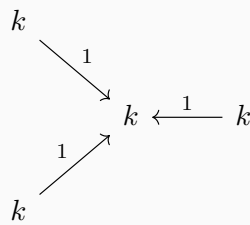
Let M :



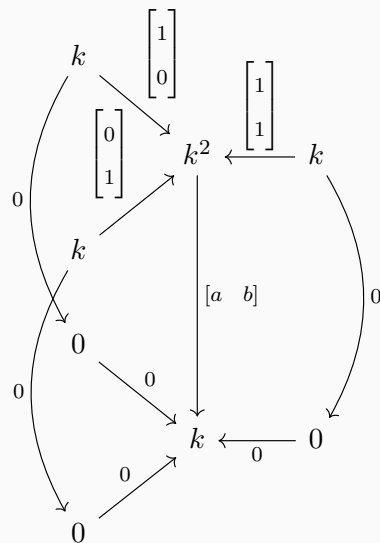
M' :



M'' :



Let us check $\text{Hom}(M, M')$:

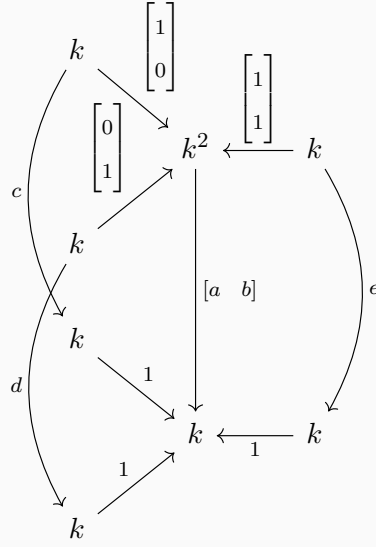


Since $M'_1 = M'_2 = M'_4 = 0$, the maps f_1, f_2, f_4 are zero. Let $f_3 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}$. The commutativity conditions impose:

$$\begin{cases} f_3\phi_\alpha = \psi_\alpha f_1 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \implies a = 0, \\ f_3\phi_\beta = \psi_\beta f_2 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \implies b = 0. \end{cases}$$

Thus $f_3 = 0$, and $\text{Hom}(M, M') = 0$.

Let us check $\text{Hom}(M, M'')$:



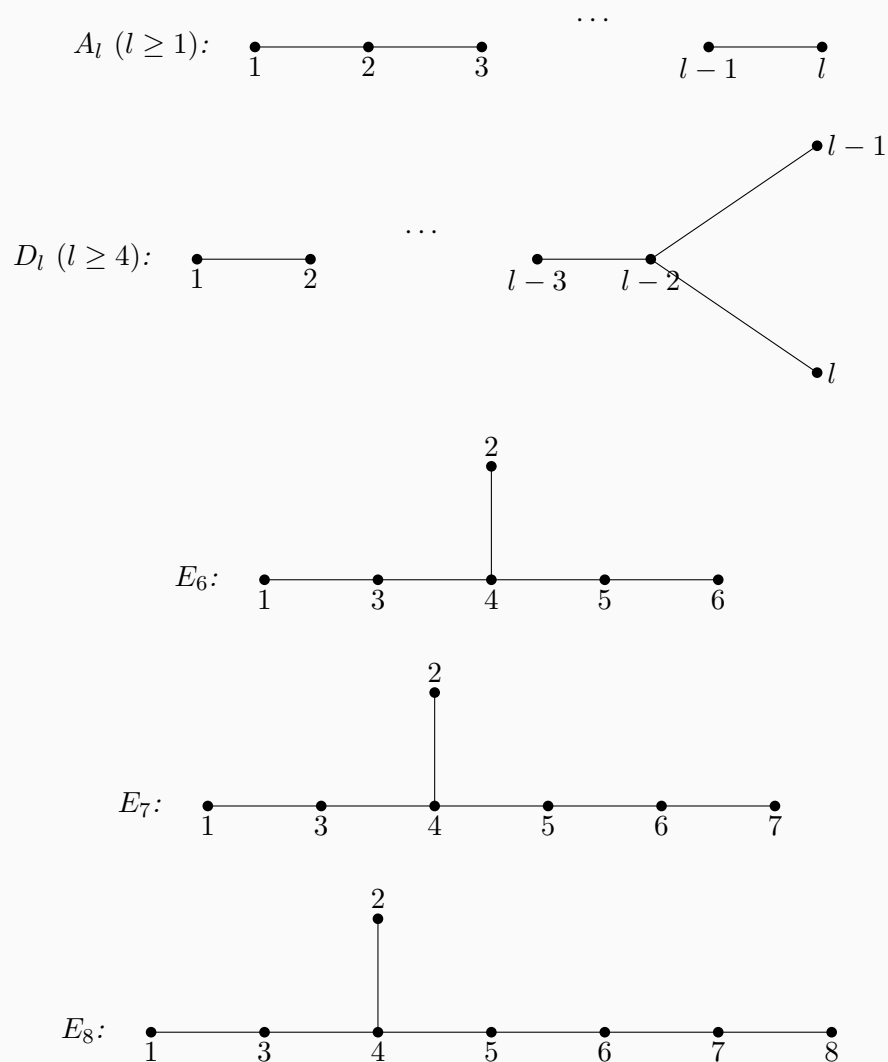
Let the morphism be given by $g_1 = [c]$, $g_2 = [d]$, $g_4 = [e]$, and $g_3 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}$. The commutativity conditions are:

$$\begin{cases} g_3\phi_\alpha = \psi_\alpha g_1 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = c \implies a = c, \\ g_3\phi_\beta = \psi_\beta g_2 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = d \implies b = d, \\ g_3\phi_\gamma = \psi_\gamma g_4 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = e \implies a + b = e. \end{cases}$$

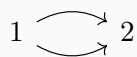
The morphism is uniquely determined by the parameters $a, b \in k$, and hence $\text{Hom}(M, M'') \cong k^2$.

1.4 Dynkin Diagrams and Classical Quivers

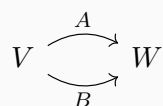
Example 1.4.1. *Dynkin Diagrams:*



Example 1.4.2. *2-Kronecker quiver:*



Representations of this quiver:



Example 1.4.3. *Jordan quiver:*



Representations of this quiver:



$A : V \rightarrow V$, the matrix representation of A is similar to a Jordan normal form (when $k = \bar{k}$).

Chapter 2

Lecture 2

2.1 Morphisms and Decompositions

Recall the definition:

Definition 2.1.1. Let $Q = (Q_0, Q_1)$ be a quiver. A representation of Q is a collection

$$M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1},$$

where each V_i is a vector space and each arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ is assigned a linear map

$$\varphi_\alpha \in \text{Hom}(V_i, V_j).$$

Example 2.1.2. Consider the 2-Kronecker quiver

$$1 \begin{array}{c} \curvearrowright \\ \curvearrowleft \end{array} 2$$

and the representations

$$M : \quad k \begin{array}{c} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \\ \xrightarrow{\quad} \\ \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \end{array} k^2$$

and

$$N : \quad k^2 \begin{array}{c} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \\ \xrightarrow{\quad} \\ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \end{array} k^2$$

Denote $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ and $N = (U_i, \psi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$. Consider the morphism $f : M \rightarrow N$. $f = (f_i)_{i \in Q_0}$. $f_i : V_i \rightarrow U_i$ and for each $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ in Q , the following

diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha} & V_j \\ f_i \downarrow & & \downarrow f_j \\ U_i & \xrightarrow{\psi_\alpha} & U_j \end{array}$$

We use $\text{Rep } Q$ to denote the category of representations of Q . For our example, we have

$$f : M \rightarrow N : f = (f_1, f_2) :$$

Let $f = (f_1, f_2) : M \rightarrow N$ be a morphism. Write

$$f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix}, \quad f_2 = \begin{bmatrix} c & d \\ e & f \end{bmatrix}.$$

Then the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} & \\ & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \\ k & & k^2 \\ & \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} & \\ f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix} \downarrow & \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} & \downarrow f_2 = \begin{bmatrix} c & d \\ e & f \end{bmatrix} \\ k^2 & \xrightarrow{\quad} & k^2 \\ & \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} & \end{array}$$

Commutativity along the two arrows gives

$$f_2 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} c \\ e \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a+b \\ b \end{bmatrix},$$

and

$$f_2 \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} d \\ f \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a+b \\ a+b \end{bmatrix}.$$

Hence

$$c = d = f = a + b, \quad e = b,$$

so

$$f = \left(\begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} a+b & a+b \\ b & a+b \end{bmatrix} \right), \quad \dim \text{Hom}(M, N) = 2.$$

This illustrates how morphisms in $\text{Rep } Q$ are determined by commutative diagrams.

Definition 2.1.3. If $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)$ and $N = (U_i, \psi_\alpha)$ are representations of Q , then their direct sum is

$$M \oplus N = \left(V_i \oplus U_i, \begin{bmatrix} \varphi_\alpha & 0 \\ 0 & \psi_\alpha \end{bmatrix} \right).$$

Inductively, one may form finite direct sums $M_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus M_r$.

Definition 2.1.4. A representation M is called indecomposable if it cannot be written as a direct sum of two non-zero representations of Q .

Remark 2.1.5. For quiver representations, indecomposable and irreducible are different notions; they do not have to coincide.

Example 2.1.6. Consider the quiver

$$1 \longrightarrow 2 \longleftarrow 3$$

and the following representations:

$$M : \quad k \xrightarrow{1} k \xleftarrow{0} 0$$

$$N : \quad k^2 \xrightarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}} k^2 \xleftarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}} k$$

Then

$$M \oplus N : \quad k \oplus k^2 \xrightarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}} k \oplus k^2 \xleftarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}} 0 \oplus k$$

Indeed, identifying

$$k \oplus k^2 \cong k^3, \quad k \oplus k^2 \cong k^3, \quad 0 \oplus k \cong k,$$

we may rewrite this as

$$k^3 \xrightarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}} k^3 \xleftarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}} k$$

Example 2.1.7. Consider the Jordan quiver:



Let A, B, C be three $n \times n$ matrices. Where C denotes an isomorphism (C is invertible). We have the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \begin{array}{c} \curvearrowright \\ \bullet \\ \dot{V} \\ \downarrow C \\ \bullet \\ \dot{V} \\ \curvearrowleft \\ B \end{array} & & \begin{array}{ccc} V & \xrightarrow{A} & V \\ C \downarrow & & \downarrow C \\ V & \xrightarrow{B} & V \end{array}
 \end{array}$$

Which shows that A and B are similar: $A = C^{-1}BC$. Hence the isomorphism classes are controlled by Jordan normal form, and the indecomposable representations correspond exactly to single Jordan blocks.

To describe $\text{Rep } Q$ we will need to describe all isomorphism classes of indecomposable representations.

Theorem 2.1.8 (Krull–Schmidt). *Any finite representation $M \in \text{Rep } Q$ can be decomposed into finite number of indecomposable representations and its decomposition is unique up to order.*

Proof. For a finite-dimensional representation $M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha)$, define

$$|M| := \sum_{i \in Q_0} \dim_k M_i.$$

We first prove the existence of a decomposition into indecomposable representations by induction on $|M|$.

If $|M| = 0$, then $M = 0$, and there is nothing to prove. If $M \neq 0$ is already indecomposable, then again there is nothing to prove. Suppose now that M is decomposable. Then there exist nonzero representations M' and M'' such that

$$M \cong M' \oplus M''.$$

Since both M' and M'' are nonzero, we have

$$|M'| < |M| \quad \text{and} \quad |M''| < |M|.$$

By the induction hypothesis, both M' and M'' decompose as finite direct sums of indecomposable representations. Hence M also decomposes as a finite direct sum of indecomposable representations. This proves existence.

We now prove uniqueness. The key point is the following claim:

Claim. Let X be a finite-dimensional indecomposable representation. Then every endomorphism $f \in \text{End}(X)$ is either invertible or nilpotent.

Indeed, since X is finite-dimensional, Fitting's lemma applies to f . Thus for $n \gg 0$,

$$X = \ker(f^n) \oplus \operatorname{im}(f^n).$$

Both $\ker(f^n)$ and $\operatorname{im}(f^n)$ are subrepresentations of X . Since X is indecomposable, one of them must be zero. If $\ker(f^n) = 0$, then f^n is injective, hence bijective, and therefore f is invertible. If $\operatorname{im}(f^n) = 0$, then $f^n = 0$, so f is nilpotent. This proves the claim.

Now suppose that

$$M \cong M_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus M_r \quad \text{and} \quad M \cong N_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus N_s,$$

where all M_i and N_j are indecomposable. We must show that $r = s$ and, after a permutation, $M_i \cong N_i$ for all i .

Fix an isomorphism

$$\varphi : \bigoplus_{i=1}^r M_i \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{j=1}^s N_j.$$

Let

$$\iota_i : M_i \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^r M_i, \quad \pi_i : \bigoplus_{i=1}^r M_i \rightarrow M_i,$$

and

$$\iota'_j : N_j \rightarrow \bigoplus_{j=1}^s N_j, \quad \pi'_j : \bigoplus_{j=1}^s N_j \rightarrow N_j$$

be the canonical injections and projections.

For a fixed i , we have

$$1_{M_i} = \pi_i \varphi^{-1} \varphi \iota_i = \sum_{j=1}^s (\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j) (\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i).$$

Thus

$$1_{M_i} = u_1 + \cdots + u_s,$$

where

$$u_j := (\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j) (\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i) \in \operatorname{End}(M_i).$$

By the claim, every endomorphism of M_i is either invertible or nilpotent. If all u_j were nilpotent, then their sum could not be the identity. Hence at least one u_j is invertible. Fix such a j . Then

$$u_j = (\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j) (\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i)$$

is an automorphism of M_i . It follows that

$$\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i : M_i \rightarrow N_j$$

is a split monomorphism (i.e. a monomorphism that has a left inverse), and

$$\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j : N_j \rightarrow M_i$$

is a split epimorphism (i.e. a epimorphism that has a right inverse). Therefore M_i is isomorphic to a direct summand of N_j . (For example, let c be the left inverse of a , then $\forall y \in N_j$ we have $y = a(c(y)) + (y - a(c(y)))$ and $a(c(y)) \in a(M_i)$ and $y - a(c(y)) \in \ker(c)$. Furthermore, $a(M_i) \cap \ker(c) = 0$). Since N_j is indecomposable, we conclude that

$$M_i \cong N_j.$$

Thus each M_i is isomorphic to some N_j . By symmetry, each N_j is isomorphic to some M_i . After reordering, we may assume

$$M_1 \cong N_1.$$

Cancelling these isomorphic summands, we obtain

$$M_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus M_r \cong N_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus N_s.$$

Repeating the argument inductively, we obtain

$$r = s$$

and, after a suitable permutation,

$$M_i \cong N_i \quad \text{for all } 1 \leq i \leq r.$$

Therefore the decomposition of M into indecomposable representations is unique up to permutation and isomorphism of the summands. $\square$

2.2 Kernel and Cokernel in $\text{Rep } Q$

Recall in linear algebra:

Definition 2.2.1. Let $f : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map. The kernel of f is $\ker f = \{v \in V : f(v) = 0\}$.

Definition 2.2.2. Let $f : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map. The image of f is $\text{im } f = \{w \in W : w = f(v) \text{ for some } v \in V\}$.

Definition 2.2.3. Let $f : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map. The cokernel of f is the quotient space $\text{coker } f = W / \text{im } f$.

Definition 2.2.4. Let $f : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map. The coimage of f is the quotient space $\text{coim } f = V / \ker f$.

The cokernel is defined using the image; below we will use $\text{im } f_i$ in the same way for

representations.

From now on we consider kernel and cokernel in $\text{Rep } Q$.

2.2.1 Kernel in $\text{Rep } Q$.

Definition 2.2.5. Let $f : M \rightarrow N$ be a morphism in $\text{Rep } Q$, with $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. The kernel of f is the representation $\ker f = (L_i, \chi_\alpha)$ where

$$L_i = \ker f_i, \quad \chi_\alpha = \varphi_\alpha|_{L_i} \quad \text{for each arrow } \alpha : i \rightarrow j.$$

So for each $v_i \in L_i$, $\chi_\alpha(v_i) = \varphi_\alpha(v_i)$.

Lemma 2.2.6. With the notation above, $\ker f$ is a representation of Q , i.e. for each arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ we have $\chi_\alpha : L_i \rightarrow L_j$ is well-defined.

Proof. For any $v_i \in L_i$ we have $f_i(v_i) = 0$. By commutativity of the morphism f ,

$$f_j(\chi_\alpha(v_i)) = f_j(\varphi_\alpha(v_i)) = \psi_\alpha(f_i(v_i)) = \psi_\alpha(0) = 0.$$

Hence $\chi_\alpha(v_i) \in \ker f_j = L_j$, so $\chi_\alpha : L_i \rightarrow L_j$ is well-defined. $\square$

Remark 2.2.7. The inclusion $L_i \hookrightarrow V_i$ at each vertex defines a morphism $\ker f \rightarrow M$ (i.e. a monomorphism). The following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_i & \xrightarrow{\chi_\alpha} & L_j \\ \downarrow \text{incl.} & & \downarrow \text{incl.} \\ V_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha} & V_j \end{array}$$

2.2.2 Cokernel in $\text{Rep } Q$.

Definition 2.2.8. Let $f : M \rightarrow N$ be a morphism in $\text{Rep } Q$, with $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. The cokernel of f is the representation $\text{coker } f = (R_i, \nu_\alpha)$ where $R_i = N_i / \text{Im } f_i$, and for each arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ the map $\nu_\alpha : R_i \rightarrow R_j$ is defined by

$$\nu_\alpha(n_i + f_i(V_i)) = \psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(V_j).$$

Lemma 2.2.9. The maps ν_α above are well-defined, and (R_i, ν_α) is a representation of Q .

Proof. Suppose $n_i + f_i(V_i) = n'_i + f_i(V_i)$. Then $n_i - n'_i \in f_i(V_i)$, so $n_i - n'_i = f_i(v_i)$ for some $v_i \in V_i$. By commutativity of f ,

$$\psi_\alpha(n_i - n'_i) = \psi_\alpha(f_i(v_i)) = f_j(\varphi_\alpha(v_i)) \in f_j(V_j).$$

Hence $\psi_\alpha(n_i) - \psi_\alpha(n'_i) \in f_j(V_j)$, so $\psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(V_j) = \psi_\alpha(n'_i) + f_j(V_j)$. Thus ν_α is well-defined. $\square$

Remark 2.2.10. *The quotient maps $N_i \rightarrow R_i$ define a morphism $N \rightarrow \text{coker } f$ (i.e. a surjective morphism). The following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} N_i & \xrightarrow{\psi_\alpha} & N_j \\ \downarrow \text{proj.} & & \downarrow \text{proj.} \\ R_i & \xrightarrow{\nu_\alpha} & R_j \end{array}$$

Chapter 3

Lecture 3

3.1 Subrepresentations and Indecomposability

Definition 3.1.1. Recall that for a morphism $f : M \rightarrow N$, we have a representation

$$\ker f \xrightarrow{\text{incl.}} M$$

A subrepresentation of M is representation L such that $f : L \rightarrow M$ is a monomorphism.

Example 3.1.2. For the quiver $1 \longrightarrow 2$ We have trivial representation

$$0 \xrightarrow{0} 0$$

The following 3 representations are non-trivial

$$k \xrightarrow{0} 0 \quad 0 \xrightarrow{0} k \quad k \xrightarrow{1} k$$

Denoted by S_1, S_2, M .

First two representations are irreducible and indecomposable, the last one is reducible but indecomposable.

To check it, first it is obvious that if M has non-trivial subrepresentations, the only possible ones are S_1 and S_2 . For S_1 consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k & \xrightarrow{0} & 0 \\ a \downarrow & & \downarrow b \\ k & \xrightarrow{1} & k \end{array}$$

Then $a=b=0$, it is impossible to construct inclusion.

But if we consider S_2 :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} 0 & \xrightarrow{0} & k \\ a \downarrow & & \downarrow b \\ k & \xrightarrow{1} & k \end{array}$$

Then $a = b \cdot 0 = 0$ and b is arbitrary (then we have a monomorphism). Hence we come to the conclusion that $\text{Hom}(S_1, M) = 0$ and $\text{Hom}(S_2, M) = k$. In other words S_2 is a subrepresentation of M and hence M is reducible.

But if S_2 is a direct summand of M , then since S_1 is not a submodule, we can not have $M = S_1 \oplus S_2$. Hence M is indecomposable.

3.2 Kernel, Cokernel, and the First Isomorphism Theorem

Definition 3.2.1 (Universal property of the kernel). *Let $f : M \rightarrow N$ be a morphism of representations. A kernel of f is a morphism $g : L \rightarrow M$ such that $f \circ g = 0$ and such that, for every morphism $h : X \rightarrow M$ with $f \circ h = 0$, there exists a unique morphism $u : X \rightarrow L$ making the diagram commute:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{u} & L \\ & \searrow h & \downarrow g \\ & & M \xrightarrow{f} N. \end{array}$$

Let us show that previous definition $\ker f = (\ker f_i = L_i, \varphi_\alpha|_{L_i})$ is equivalent to the universal property definition with $L = \ker f, g_i = \text{incl.}$ i.e. $\ker f_i \xrightarrow{\text{incl.}} M_i$ where $f_i g_i = 0$.

Proof. Let

$$f = (f_i) : M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha) \longrightarrow N = (N_i, \rho_\alpha)$$

be a morphism of representations. For each vertex i , set

$$L_i := \ker f_i \subseteq M_i.$$

For each arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$, define

$$\psi_\alpha := \varphi_\alpha|_{L_i} : L_i \rightarrow L_j.$$

Therefore

$$L = (L_i, \psi_\alpha)$$

is a representation. Let

$$g = (g_i) : L \rightarrow M$$

be given by the inclusion maps

$$g_i : L_i = \ker f_i \hookrightarrow M_i.$$

Then for each vertex i ,

$$f_i \circ g_i = 0,$$

so

$$f \circ g = 0.$$

We now show that (L, g) satisfies the universal property of the kernel.

Let

$$h = (h_i) : X = (X_i, \nu_\alpha) \rightarrow M$$

be any morphism of representations such that

$$f \circ h = 0.$$

Then for every vertex i ,

$$f_i \circ h_i = 0.$$

Thus, for every $x_i \in X_i$,

$$f_i(h_i(x_i)) = 0,$$

which means that

$$h_i(x_i) \in \ker f_i = L_i.$$

Hence each h_i factors through L_i , so we may define a linear map

$$u_i : X_i \rightarrow L_i, \quad u_i(x_i) := h_i(x_i).$$

By construction,

$$g_i \circ u_i = h_i$$

for every vertex i .

It remains to check that $u = (u_i) : X \rightarrow L$ is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ be an arrow and let $x_i \in X_i$. Then

$$\psi_\alpha(u_i(x_i)) = \psi_\alpha(h_i(x_i)) = \varphi_\alpha(h_i(x_i)) = h_j(\nu_\alpha(x_i)) = u_j(\nu_\alpha(x_i)).$$

Therefore

$$\psi_\alpha \circ u_i = u_j \circ \nu_\alpha$$

for every arrow α , so u is indeed a morphism of representations.

Finally, uniqueness is clear. If

$$u' = (u'_i) : X \rightarrow L$$

is another morphism such that

$$g \circ u' = h,$$

then for each vertex i ,

$$g_i \circ u'_i = h_i.$$

Since $g_i : L_i \hookrightarrow M_i$ is just the inclusion map, it follows that

$$u'_i(x_i) = h_i(x_i) = u_i(x_i)$$

for all $x_i \in X_i$. Hence $u'_i = u_i$ for all i , and so $u' = u$.

Thus (L, g) satisfies the universal property of the kernel. Therefore the representation

$$L = (\ker f_i, \varphi_\alpha|_{\ker f_i})$$

with the inclusion morphism $g : L \rightarrow M$ is precisely the kernel of f .

Conversely, suppose that (L, g) is a kernel of f in the sense of the universal property. Thus

$$g = (g_i) : L = (L_i, \chi_\alpha) \rightarrow M$$

satisfies

$$f \circ g = 0.$$

Since

$$f_i \circ g_i = 0$$

for every vertex i , we have

$$g_i(L_i) \subseteq \ker f_i = K_i.$$

Hence the morphism $g : L \rightarrow M$ factors through the inclusion

$$\iota : K \rightarrow M.$$

By the universal property of (K, ι) already proved above, there exists a unique morphism

$$\theta : L \rightarrow K$$

such that

$$\iota \circ \theta = g.$$

On the other hand, since

$$f \circ \iota = 0,$$

the universal property of (L, g) implies that there exists a unique morphism

$$\eta : K \rightarrow L$$

such that

$$g \circ \eta = \iota.$$

We now show that θ and η are inverse isomorphisms. Indeed,

$$\iota \circ (\theta \circ \eta) = (\iota \circ \theta) \circ \eta = g \circ \eta = \iota.$$

But also

$$\iota \circ 1_K = \iota.$$

Since (K, ι) satisfies the universal property, the morphism from K to K factoring ι through ι is unique. Therefore

$$\theta \circ \eta = 1_K.$$

Similarly,

$$g \circ (\eta \circ \theta) = (g \circ \eta) \circ \theta = \iota \circ \theta = g,$$

and also

$$g \circ 1_L = g.$$

By the universal property of (L, g) , the factorization of g through g is unique, hence

$$\eta \circ \theta = 1_L.$$

Thus θ and η are inverse isomorphisms, so

$$L \cong K.$$

Therefore any kernel of f defined by the universal property is isomorphic to the representation

$$(\ker f_i, \varphi_\alpha|_{\ker f_i}),$$

and the two definitions of the kernel are equivalent. $\square$

Analogously we have equivalent definition of coker f .

Definition 3.2.2 (Universal property of cokernel). *A cokernel of f is a morphism*

$$g : N \rightarrow H$$

such that $g \circ f = 0$ and satisfying the following universal property: for every representation Y and every morphism $h : N \rightarrow Y$ with $h \circ f = 0$, there exists a unique morphism $u : H \rightarrow Y$ such that

$$u \circ g = h.$$

Equivalently, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} M & \xrightarrow{f} & N & \xrightarrow{g} & H \\ & & & \searrow h & \downarrow u \\ & & & & Y \end{array}$$

Exercise 3.2.3. *Prove the equivalence of the two definitions of coker f .*

Proof. Let

$$f = (f_i) : M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha) \rightarrow N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$$

be a morphism of representations. For each vertex i , define

$$H_i := N_i / f_i(M_i).$$

For each arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$, define

$$\chi_\alpha(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := \psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j).$$

Hence

$$H = (H_i, \chi_\alpha)$$

is a representation.

Now let

$$g = (g_i) : N \rightarrow H$$

be the natural quotient morphism, where

$$g_i : N_i \rightarrow N_i / f_i(M_i), \quad g_i(n_i) = n_i + f_i(M_i).$$

Then for every vertex i and every $m_i \in M_i$,

$$(g_i \circ f_i)(m_i) = f_i(m_i) + f_i(M_i) = 0.$$

Thus

$$g \circ f = 0.$$

We now prove the universal property. Let

$$h = (h_i) : N \rightarrow Y = (Y_i, \eta_\alpha)$$

be a morphism such that

$$h \circ f = 0.$$

Then for each vertex i ,

$$h_i \circ f_i = 0.$$

Hence h_i vanishes on $f_i(M_i)$, so it factors uniquely through the quotient $N_i / f_i(M_i)$. Therefore there exists a unique linear map

$$u_i : H_i = N_i / f_i(M_i) \rightarrow Y_i$$

such that

$$u_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := h_i(n_i).$$

This is well-defined because if

$$n_i + f_i(M_i) = n'_i + f_i(M_i),$$

then $n_i - n'_i = f_i(m_i)$ for some $m_i \in M_i$, and hence

$$h_i(n_i) - h_i(n'_i) = h_i(f_i(m_i)) = 0.$$

By construction,

$$u_i \circ g_i = h_i$$

for every vertex i .

It remains to check that $u = (u_i) : H \rightarrow Y$ is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ be an arrow and let $n_i + f_i(M_i) \in H_i$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \eta_\alpha(u_i(n_i + f_i(M_i))) &= \eta_\alpha(h_i(n_i)) = h_j(\psi_\alpha(n_i)) = u_j(\psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j)) \\ &= u_j(\chi_\alpha(n_i + f_i(M_i))). \end{aligned}$$

Therefore

$$\eta_\alpha \circ u_i = u_j \circ \chi_\alpha,$$

so u is a morphism of representations.

Finally, uniqueness is clear: if

$$u' = (u'_i) : H \rightarrow Y$$

also satisfies

$$u' \circ g = h,$$

then for each i ,

$$u'_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)) = u'_i(g_i(n_i)) = h_i(n_i) = u_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)).$$

Thus $u'_i = u_i$ for all i , so $u' = u$.

Therefore the quotient representation

$$(N_i/f_i(M_i), \chi_\alpha)$$

with the natural projection $g : N \rightarrow H$ satisfies the universal property of the cokernel.

On the other hand, suppose

$$g = (g_i) : N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha) \rightarrow H = (H_i, \chi_\alpha)$$

is a cokernel of

$$f = (f_i) : M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha) \rightarrow N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$$

in the sense of the universal property.

Let

$$C := (N_i/f_i(M_i), \bar{\psi}_\alpha)$$

be the pointwise cokernel representation, where

$$\overline{\psi}_\alpha(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := \psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j).$$

Let

$$\pi = (\pi_i) : N \rightarrow C$$

be the natural quotient morphism. As shown above,

$$\pi \circ f = 0.$$

Since $g : N \rightarrow H$ is a cokernel of f , applying its universal property to the morphism

$$\pi : N \rightarrow C$$

with $\pi \circ f = 0$, there exists a unique morphism

$$a : H \rightarrow C$$

such that

$$a \circ g = \pi.$$

On the other hand, since $g \circ f = 0$, for each vertex i we have

$$g_i \circ f_i = 0.$$

Thus g_i vanishes on $f_i(M_i)$, so it factors uniquely through the quotient

$$N_i / f_i(M_i).$$

Hence for each i there exists a unique linear map

$$b_i : C_i = N_i / f_i(M_i) \rightarrow H_i$$

given by

$$b_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := g_i(n_i).$$

These maps assemble into a morphism

$$b : C \rightarrow H,$$

because for any arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$,

$$\chi_\alpha(b_i(n_i + f_i(M_i))) = \chi_\alpha(g_i(n_i)) = g_j(\psi_\alpha(n_i)) = b_j(\psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j)) = b_j(\overline{\psi}_\alpha(n_i + f_i(M_i))).$$

So

$$b \circ \pi = g.$$

We now show that a and b are inverse isomorphisms.

First,

$$(a \circ b) \circ \pi = a \circ (b \circ \pi) = a \circ g = \pi.$$

Also,

$$\text{id}_C \circ \pi = \pi.$$

Since $\pi : N \rightarrow C$ is a cokernel of f , the uniqueness part of its universal property implies

$$a \circ b = \text{id}_C.$$

Similarly,

$$(b \circ a) \circ g = b \circ (a \circ g) = b \circ \pi = g,$$

and also

$$\text{id}_H \circ g = g.$$

Since $g : N \rightarrow H$ is a cokernel of f , the uniqueness part of its universal property implies

$$b \circ a = \text{id}_H.$$

Therefore a and b are inverse isomorphisms, and hence

$$H \cong C = (N_i/f_i(M_i), \overline{\psi}_\alpha).$$

In particular, for each vertex i we have

$$H_i \cong N_i/f_i(M_i),$$

and under these identifications, for every arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$,

$$\chi_\alpha = a_j^{-1} \circ \overline{\psi}_\alpha \circ a_i.$$

Thus any cokernel given by the universal property is isomorphic to the pointwise quotient representation

$$(N_i/f_i(M_i), \psi_\alpha \text{ induced on the quotients}).$$

□

Theorem 3.2.4 (the first isomorphism theorem). *If $f : M \rightarrow N$ is a morphism of representations, then $\text{im } f \cong M/\ker f$.*

Proof. Write

$$M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha), \quad N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha).$$

Then

$$\text{im } f = (\text{im } f_i, \psi_\alpha|_{\text{im } f_i}).$$

This is a representation, since for every arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ and every $m_i \in M_i$,

$$\psi_\alpha(f_i(m_i)) = f_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) \in \text{im } f_j.$$

Also,

$$M/\ker f = (M_i/\ker f_i, \bar{\varphi}_\alpha),$$

where for $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$,

$$\bar{\varphi}_\alpha(m_i + \ker f_i) = \varphi_\alpha(m_i) + \ker f_j.$$

For each vertex i , the first isomorphism theorem for vector spaces gives an isomorphism

$$\bar{f}_i : M_i/\ker f_i \longrightarrow \text{im } f_i, \quad \bar{f}_i(m_i + \ker f_i) = f_i(m_i).$$

We claim that $\bar{f} = (\bar{f}_i)$ is a morphism of representations. Consider the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M_i/\ker f_i & \xrightarrow{\bar{\varphi}_\alpha} & M_j/\ker f_j \\ \bar{f}_i \downarrow & & \downarrow \bar{f}_j \\ \text{im } f_i & \xrightarrow{\psi_\alpha|_{\text{im } f_i}} & \text{im } f_j \end{array}$$

For any $m_i \in M_i$,

$$\begin{aligned} \bar{f}_j(\bar{\varphi}_\alpha(m_i + \ker f_i)) &= \bar{f}_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i) + \ker f_j) \\ &= f_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) = \psi_\alpha(f_i(m_i)) \\ &= \psi_\alpha|_{\text{im } f_i}(\bar{f}_i(m_i + \ker f_i)). \end{aligned}$$

Hence the diagram commutes for every arrow α , so $\bar{f} : M/\ker f \rightarrow \text{im } f$ is a morphism in $\text{Rep } Q$. Since each $\bar{f}_i$ is an isomorphism, $\bar{f}$ is an isomorphism of representations. Therefore

$$M/\ker f \cong \text{im } f.$$

□

These all together shows that $\text{Rep } Q$ is an abelian category.

Definition 3.2.5. We call a category $\mathcal{C}$ abelian k -category if the following conditions are satisfied:

1. $\mathcal{C}$ is k -category, for any $X, Y \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$ is a vector space over k .
2. $\mathcal{C}$ is a additive category, $\mathcal{C}$ has direct sums and zero object.
3. Each morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ has kernel K and cokernel H . $f : M \rightarrow N$, $i : K \rightarrow M$, $p : N \rightarrow H$. and $\text{coker } i \cong \ker p$.

3.3 Exact and Split Exact Sequences

Definition 3.3.1. Let $M \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow P$ be a sequence of morphisms in $\text{Rep } Q$. We say that this sequence is exact (at N) if $\ker p = \text{im } f$.

Definition 3.3.2. We call a sequence of morphisms in $\text{Rep } Q$ a short exact sequence if it is exact and of the form

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

Where f is injective, g is surjective, $\text{im } f = \ker g$

For $f : M \rightarrow N$ we have exact sequence:

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker f \xrightarrow{i} M \xrightarrow{f} N \xrightarrow{p} \text{coker } f \longrightarrow 0$$

Where i is an inclusion and p is a projection.

Or we have short exact sequence:

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker f \xrightarrow{i} M \xrightarrow{p} M/\ker f \longrightarrow 0$$

Example 3.3.3. The quiver is given by:

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Consider the following representations:

- $S_1: k \xrightarrow{0} 0$
- $S_2: 0 \xrightarrow{0} k$
- $M: k \xrightarrow{1} k$

Exact Sequences: The following short exact sequences are presented:

$$0 \longrightarrow S_2 \xrightarrow{(0,1)} M \xrightarrow{(1,0)} S_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow S_2 \xrightarrow{(0,1)} S_1 \oplus S_2 \xrightarrow{(1,0)} S_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

Both sequences are exact.

Definition 3.3.4. A morphism $f : L \rightarrow M$ is a section if there exists a morphism $h : M \rightarrow L$ such that $hf = 1_L$. A morphism $g : M \rightarrow N$ is a retraction if there exists a morphism $h : N \rightarrow M$ such that $gh = 1_N$.

Definition 3.3.5. We say that a short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

splits if f has a retraction or equivalently f is a section.

Example 3.3.6. In the example before, the second sequence splits.

Take the first short exact sequence: the middle term is the direct sum $S_1 \oplus S_2$, with

$f = (0, 1)$ (inclusion of the second summand), $g = (1, 0)$ (projection onto the first).

Take the projection $h: S_1 \oplus S_2 \rightarrow S_2$ onto the second factor (at each vertex). Then

$$(hf)(s_2) = h(0, s_2) = s_2 \quad \forall s_2 \in S_2, \quad \text{so } hf = 1_{S_2}.$$

Thus f has a retraction and the sequence splits. Equivalently, the inclusion $h': S_1 \rightarrow S_1 \oplus S_2$ of the first summand satisfies $gh' = 1_{S_1}$, so g has a section.

By contrast, take the second short exact sequence: the middle term here is M , the representation

$$k \xrightarrow{1} k,$$

which is indecomposable and not isomorphic to $S_1 \oplus S_2$. There is no morphism from M to S_2 giving a retraction of f , so the first sequence does not split.

Chapter 4

Lecture 4

4.1 Split Exact Sequences

Recall short exact sequence:

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

Where $\ker f = L$, $\operatorname{im} f = \ker g$, $\operatorname{im} g = N$.

f is section if $\exists h : M \rightarrow L$ such that $hf = 1_L$. g is retraction if $\exists h' : N \rightarrow M$ such that $gh' = 1_N$.

Theorem 4.1.1. *Taking a short exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

1. f is a section if and only if g is a retraction.
2. If f is a section then $\ker g = \operatorname{im} f$ is a direct summand of M .

proof of (a). ($\Rightarrow$): Suppose f is a section. $\exists h : M \rightarrow L$ such that $hf = 1_L$. We will define $h' : N \rightarrow M$ and show that $gh' = 1_N$. $\forall n \in N$, since g is surjective $\exists m$ such that $n = g(m)$. $h'(n) = m - f(h(m))$ where $h' : N \rightarrow M$. We have to show that h' is well-defined. Suppose m, m' such that $n = g(m) = g(m')$. We have to show that $m' - f(h(m')) = m - f(h(m))$.

Since $g(m) - g(m') = g(m - m') = 0$, $m - m' \in \ker g = \operatorname{im} f$, $\exists l \in L$ such that $f(l) = m - m'$. Hence $m - m' = f(l) = f(hf)(l) = f(h(m) - h(m')) = f(h(m)) - f(h(m'))$. Hence $m' - f(h(m')) = m - f(h(m))$.

We need to show h' is a morphism. Let $M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha)$, $L = (L_i, \varphi'_\alpha)$, $N = (N_i, \varphi''_\alpha)$. Then f, g, h are morphisms of representations. We have to show that h' is a morphism of

representations. Let $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ be an arrow in Q . Then consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
L_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi'_\alpha} & L_j \\
f_i \downarrow \uparrow h_i & & h_j \downarrow \uparrow f_j \\
M_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha} & M_j \\
g_i \downarrow \uparrow h'_i & & h'_j \downarrow \uparrow g_j \\
N_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi''_\alpha} & N_j
\end{array}$$

Take $n_i \in N_i$, and for n_i we choose m_i such that $g_i(m_i) = n_i, h'_i(n_i) = m_i - f_i(h_i(m_i))$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\varphi_\alpha h'_i(n_i) &= \varphi_\alpha(m_i - f_i(h_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - \varphi_\alpha(f_i(h_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - f_j(\varphi'_\alpha(h_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)))
\end{aligned}$$

And

$$\begin{aligned}
h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(n_i)) &= h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(g_i(m_i))) \\
&= h'_j(g_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))) \\
&\text{(define } n_j = g_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) \text{)} \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)))
\end{aligned}$$

Hence h' is a morphism of representations.

The only thing need to show now is that $gh' = 1_N$. Let $n_i \in N_i$, then $\exists m_i \in M_i$ such that $n_i = g_i(m_i)$. Then $g_i(h'_i(n_i)) = g_i(m_i - f_i(h_i(m_i))) = g_i(m_i) - g_i(f_i(h_i(m_i))) = g_i(m_i) = n_i$. Hence $gh' = 1_N$. (Since $f_i(h_i(m_i)) \in \text{im } f_i = \ker g_i$).

($\Leftarrow$): Suppose g is a retraction. $\exists h' : N \rightarrow M$ such that $gh' = 1_N$. We will define $h : M \rightarrow L$ and show that $hf = 1_L$.

For any m we have $g(m - h'g(m)) = g(m) - g(h'g(m)) = g(m) - g(m) = 0$. Hence $m - h'g(m) \in \ker g = \text{im } f$. Hence $\exists l \in L$ such that $f(l) = m - h'g(m)$ since f is injective. Define $h(m) = l$.

We have to show that h is a morphism of representations. Let $M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha), L = (L_i, \varphi'_\alpha), N = (N_i, \varphi''_\alpha)$. Then f, g, h' are morphisms of representations. We have to show that h is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ be an arrow in Q . Then consider

the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
L_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi'_\alpha} & L_j \\
f_i \downarrow \uparrow h_i & & h_j \downarrow \uparrow f_j \\
M_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha} & M_j \\
g_i \downarrow \uparrow h'_i & & h'_j \downarrow \uparrow g_j \\
N_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi''_\alpha} & N_j
\end{array}$$

Take $m_i \in M_i$, and for m_i we choose $l_i \in L_i$ such that $f_i(l_i) = m_i - h'_i g_i(m_i)$ and $h_i(m_i) = l_i$. Then we have

$$\varphi'_\alpha(h_i(m_i)) = \varphi'_\alpha(l_i)$$

On the other hand,

$$\begin{aligned}
f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))) &= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - h'_j g_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(g_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - \varphi_\alpha(h'_i g_i(m_i)) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i - h'_i g_i(m_i)) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(f_i(l_i)) \\
&= f_j(\varphi'_\alpha(l_i))
\end{aligned}$$

Hence $f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))) = f_j(\varphi'_\alpha(l_i))$. Since f_j is injective, $h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) = \varphi'_\alpha(l_i)$. Hence h is a morphism of representations. $\square$

proof of (b). Suppose f is a section then g is a retraction. $\forall m \in M$, $\exists h : M \rightarrow L$ such that $hf = 1_L$ and $\exists h' : N \rightarrow M$ such that $gh' = 1_N$. Then $m = h'g(m) + (m - h'g(m))$ where $h'g(m) \in \text{im } h'$ and $m - h'g(m) \in \ker g$. And $\text{im } h' \cap \ker g = 0$. Thus $M_i = \ker g \oplus \text{im } h'$ as vector spaces.

Furthermore we need to show that $\ker g \oplus \text{im } h'$ is a direct sum of representations. i.e.

$$\varphi_\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} \varphi_\alpha|_{\ker g_i} & 0 \\ 0 & \varphi_\alpha|_{\text{im } h'_i} \end{bmatrix}$$

Let $m_i \in \ker g_i$, then $0 = \varphi''_\alpha(g_i(m_i)) = g_j \varphi'_\alpha(m_i)$ where $\varphi'_\alpha(m_i) \in \ker g_j$ and hence the upper right block of the matrix is zero.

If $m_i \in \text{im } h'_i$, and therefore

$$\varphi_\alpha(m_i) = \varphi_\alpha(h'_i(n_i)) = h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(n_i))$$

is an element of $\text{im } h'_j$. This shows that the lower left block of the matrix is zero and hence φ_α is a block diagonal matrix. $\square$

Corollary 4.1.2. *If*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is a short exact split sequence in $\text{Rep } Q$, then $M = L \oplus N$ as representations.

Proof. f is injective, $L \cong \text{im } f = \ker g$. By isomorphism theorem $M/\ker g \cong N$. Since g is surjective, $N \cong \text{im } g$. Statement follows from (b) of the previous theorem. $\square$

4.2 Hom Functor

Definition 4.2.1. *Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}'$ be two categories. A **covariant functor** $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}'$ is a map that assigns to each object $X \in \mathcal{C}$ an object $F(X) \in \mathcal{C}'$ and to each morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ in $\mathcal{C}$ a morphism $F(f) : F(X) \rightarrow F(Y)$ in $\mathcal{C}'$, satisfying the following conditions:*

- $F(f \circ g) = F(f) \circ F(g)$ for all morphisms $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ in $\mathcal{C}$.
- $F(\text{id}_X) = \text{id}_{F(X)}$ for all objects $X \in \mathcal{C}$.

*If $F(f \circ g) = F(g) \circ F(f)$ for all morphisms $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ in $\mathcal{C}$, then F is called a **contravariant functor**.*

If $X \in \text{Rep } Q$ then $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, -)$ is a covariant functor from $\text{Rep } Q$ to the category of k -vector spaces where $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(-, X)$ is a contravariant functor from $\text{Rep } Q$ to the category of k -vector spaces.

Example 4.2.2. *Fix $X \in \text{Rep } Q$. Let $M, N \in \text{Rep } Q$. Then $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(X, M)$ is a k -vector space. For a morphism $f : M \rightarrow N$, define*

$$\text{Hom}(X, f) := f_* : \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(X, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(X, N), \quad f_*(g) = f \circ g.$$

This is a k -linear map. This map f_ is called the **pushforward** of f . For $g \in \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(X, M)$, the image $f_*(g) = f \circ g$ is the composite in $\text{Rep } Q$; the following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X & \xrightarrow{g} & M & \xrightarrow{f} & N \\ & & \searrow & \nearrow & \\ & & f_*(g) = f \circ g & & \end{array}$$

Example 4.2.3. *Fix $X \in \text{Rep } Q$. Let $M, N \in \text{Rep } Q$. Then $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(M, X)$ and $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(N, X)$ are k -vector spaces. For a morphism $f : M \rightarrow N$, define*

$$\text{Hom}(f, X) := f^* : \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(N, X) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(M, X), \quad f^*(g) = g \circ f.$$

This is a k -linear map. This map f^ is called the **pullback** of f . For $g \in$*

$\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep } Q}(N, X)$, the image $f^*(g) = g \circ f$ is the composite in $\text{Rep } Q$; the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} M & \xrightarrow{f} & N & \xrightarrow{g} & X \\ & \searrow & & \nearrow & \\ & & f^*(g)=g \circ f & & \end{array}$$

Chapter 5

Lecture 5

5.1 Hom Functor Acts on Exact Sequences

Theorem 5.1.1. *Let Q be a quiver.*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

a sequence of representations in $\text{Rep } Q$. Then this sequence is exact if and only if for every $X \in \text{Rep } Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(X, f)} \text{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(X, g)} \text{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact.

Proof. Assume first that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact in $\text{Rep } Q$. We show that for every $X \in \text{Rep } Q$, the induced sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(X, f)} \text{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(X, g)} \text{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact.

Since f is a monomorphism, if $u, v \in \text{Hom}(X, L)$ satisfy

$$\text{Hom}(X, f)(u) = \text{Hom}(X, f)(v),$$

then $f \circ u = f \circ v$, hence $u = v$. Therefore $\text{Hom}(X, f)$ is injective.

Next, since $g \circ f = 0$, we have

$$\text{Hom}(X, g) \circ \text{Hom}(X, f) = \text{Hom}(X, g \circ f) = 0,$$

so

$$\text{im } \text{Hom}(X, f) \subseteq \ker \text{Hom}(X, g).$$

Conversely, let $h \in \text{Hom}(X, M)$ satisfy $\text{Hom}(X, g)(h) = 0$, that is, $g \circ h = 0$. Since the original sequence is exact, $f : L \rightarrow M$ is the kernel of g . Hence, by the universal property of the kernel, there exists a unique morphism $u : X \rightarrow L$ such that

$$f \circ u = h.$$

Thus $h = \text{Hom}(X, f)(u)$, so

$$\ker \text{Hom}(X, g) \subseteq \text{im } \text{Hom}(X, f).$$

Therefore

$$\ker \text{Hom}(X, g) = \text{im } \text{Hom}(X, f),$$

and the induced sequence is exact.

Conversely, assume that for every $X \in \text{Rep } Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(X, f)} \text{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(X, g)} \text{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact. We prove that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact.

We first show that $g \circ f = 0$. Take $X = L$. Since

$$\text{Hom}(L, g) \circ \text{Hom}(L, f) = 0,$$

evaluating at $1_L \in \text{Hom}(L, L)$ gives

$$g \circ f = 0.$$

Next we show that f is a monomorphism. Let $K = \ker f$, and let

$$\iota : K \rightarrow L$$

be the kernel morphism. Then

$$f \circ \iota = 0,$$

so

$$\text{Hom}(K, f)(\iota) = 0.$$

By assumption, the map

$$\text{Hom}(K, f) : \text{Hom}(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(K, M)$$

is injective, hence $\iota = 0$. Therefore $K = 0$, so f is a monomorphism.

Finally, we show that $\ker g = \text{im } f$. Let $K = \ker g$, with kernel morphism

$$\kappa : K \rightarrow M.$$

Since $g \circ \kappa = 0$, we have

$$\text{Hom}(K, g)(\kappa) = 0.$$

By the exactness of

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(K, L) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(K, f)} \text{Hom}(K, M) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(K, g)} \text{Hom}(K, N),$$

there exists a morphism $u : K \rightarrow L$ such that

$$\text{Hom}(K, f)(u) = \kappa,$$

that is,

$$f \circ u = \kappa.$$

Thus κ factors through f , which implies

$$\ker g \subseteq \text{im } f.$$

On the other hand, since $g \circ f = 0$, we have

$$\text{im } f \subseteq \ker g.$$

Hence

$$\ker g = \text{im } f.$$

Therefore the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact. □

Similarly we have the following theorem:

Theorem 5.1.2. *Let Q be a quiver.*

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

a sequence of representations in $\text{Rep } Q$. Then this sequence is exact if and only if for every $X \in \text{Rep } Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(N, X) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(f, X)} \text{Hom}(M, X) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(g, X)} \text{Hom}(L, X)$$

is exact.

Proof. Assume first that

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact in $\text{Rep } Q$. We show that for every $X \in \text{Rep } Q$, the induced sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(N, X) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(f, X)} \text{Hom}(M, X) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(g, X)} \text{Hom}(L, X)$$

is exact.

Since f is an epimorphism, if $u, v \in \text{Hom}(N, X)$ satisfy

$$\text{Hom}(f, X)(u) = \text{Hom}(f, X)(v),$$

then $u \circ f = v \circ f$, hence $u = v$. Therefore $\text{Hom}(f, X)$ is injective.

Next, since $f \circ g = 0$, we have

$$\text{Hom}(g, X) \circ \text{Hom}(f, X) = \text{Hom}(f \circ g, X) = 0,$$

so

$$\text{im } \text{Hom}(f, X) \subseteq \ker \text{Hom}(g, X).$$

Conversely, let $h \in \text{Hom}(M, X)$ satisfy $\text{Hom}(g, X)(h) = 0$, that is, $h \circ g = 0$. Since the original sequence is exact, $f : M \rightarrow N$ is the cokernel of g . Hence, by the universal property of the cokernel, there exists a unique morphism $u : N \rightarrow X$ such that

$$u \circ f = h.$$

Thus $h = \text{Hom}(f, X)(u)$, so

$$\ker \text{Hom}(g, X) \subseteq \text{im } \text{Hom}(f, X).$$

Therefore

$$\ker \text{Hom}(g, X) = \text{im } \text{Hom}(f, X),$$

and the induced sequence is exact.

Conversely, assume that for every $X \in \text{Rep } Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(N, X) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(f, X)} \text{Hom}(M, X) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(g, X)} \text{Hom}(L, X)$$

is exact. We prove that

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

We first show that $f \circ g = 0$. Take $X = N$. Since

$$\text{Hom}(g, N) \circ \text{Hom}(f, N) = 0,$$

evaluating at $1_N \in \text{Hom}(N, N)$ gives

$$f \circ g = 0.$$

Next we show that f is an epimorphism. Let $C = \text{coker } f$, and let

$$\pi : N \rightarrow C$$

be the cokernel morphism. Then

$$\pi \circ f = 0,$$

so

$$\text{Hom}(f, C)(\pi) = 0.$$

By assumption, the map

$$\text{Hom}(f, C) : \text{Hom}(N, C) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(M, C)$$

is injective, hence $\pi = 0$. Therefore $C = 0$, so f is an epimorphism.

Finally, we show that $\ker f = \text{im } g$. Let $C = \text{coker } g$, with cokernel morphism

$$\gamma : M \rightarrow C.$$

Since $\gamma \circ g = 0$, we have

$$\text{Hom}(g, C)(\gamma) = 0.$$

By the exactness of

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(N, C) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(f, C)} \text{Hom}(M, C) \xrightarrow{\text{Hom}(g, C)} \text{Hom}(L, C),$$

there exists a morphism $u : N \rightarrow C$ such that

$$\text{Hom}(f, C)(u) = \gamma,$$

that is,

$$u \circ f = \gamma.$$

Thus γ factors through f , which implies

$$\ker f \subseteq \text{im } g.$$

On the other hand, since $f \circ g = 0$, we have

$$\text{im } g \subseteq \ker f.$$

Hence

$$\ker f = \text{im } g.$$

Therefore the sequence

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact. □

Corollary 5.1.3. *Let*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

be a sequence in $\text{rep } Q$. Then the sequence is split exact if and only if, for every $X \in \text{rep } Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \text{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \text{Hom}(X, N) \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

Proof. Assume first that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is split exact. By Theorem above, it is enough to show that

$$g_* : \text{Hom}(X, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(X, N)$$

is surjective for every $X \in \text{rep } Q$.

Since the sequence is split exact, the morphism g is a retraction. Hence there exists

$$h \in \text{Hom}(N, M)$$

such that

$$gh = 1_N.$$

Now let $u \in \text{Hom}(X, N)$. Then $hu \in \text{Hom}(X, M)$, and

$$g_*(hu) = g \circ h \circ u = 1_N \circ u = u.$$

Thus every element of $\text{Hom}(X, N)$ lies in the image of g_* , so g_* is surjective. Therefore

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \text{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \text{Hom}(X, N) \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

Conversely, suppose that for every $X \in \text{rep } Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \text{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \text{Hom}(X, N) \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

By Theorem above, it follows that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact. It remains to show that this exact sequence splits.

Take $X = N$. Since

$$g_* : \text{Hom}(N, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(N, N)$$

is surjective, there exists

$$h \in \text{Hom}(N, M)$$

such that

$$g_*(h) = 1_N.$$

By definition of g_* , this means

$$g \circ h = 1_N.$$

Hence g is a retraction, and therefore the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is split exact. □

Example 5.1.4. *Let Q be the quiver*

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Consider S_1, S_2, M defined as before.

$$S_1 : k \longrightarrow 0$$

$$S_2 : 0 \longrightarrow k$$

$$M : k \xrightarrow{1} k$$

We have the following sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow S_2 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow S_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact. But non-split.

Now consider the Hom functor $\text{Hom}(S_1, -)$. Apply to this sequence, we get the following sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(S_1, S_2) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(S_1, M) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(S_1, S_1) \longrightarrow 0$$

Then $\text{Hom}(S_1, S_2) = \text{Hom}(S_1, M) = 0$ and $\text{Hom}(S_1, S_1) = k$. Therefore the "Hom-sequence" can never be exact.

5.2 First Examples of Auslander–Reiten Quivers

The goal of the representation theory of a quiver Q is to understand the representations in $\text{Rep } Q$, the morphisms between them, and, more generally, the short exact sequences in

$\text{Rep } Q$.

A first approximation to this structure is given by the *Auslander–Reiten quiver*. In the representation-finite case, it encodes all indecomposable representations, the irreducible morphisms between them, and the basic non-split short exact sequences. (In fact almost split sequences, you can check the definition in the book of Schiffler).

In this section we present only the first examples. A systematic treatment will be given later.

General idea

Let Q be a quiver. The *Auslander–Reiten quiver* Γ_Q is a quiver defined as follows.

- Its vertices are the isomorphism classes of indecomposable representations of Q .
- Its arrows correspond to *irreducible morphisms* between indecomposable representations.

Very roughly, an irreducible morphism is a morphism between indecomposable representations that does not factor in a nontrivial way through another representation.

Thus:

- indecomposable representations are the building blocks of all representations;
- irreducible morphisms are the basic building blocks of many morphisms;
- almost split sequences appear in the Auslander–Reiten quiver in the form of *meshes*.

We now look at the first examples.

Example 1: the quiver $1 \rightarrow 2$

Let

$$Q : \quad 1 \longrightarrow 2.$$

Up to isomorphism, there are exactly three indecomposable representations:

$$S(2) = (0 \longrightarrow k), \quad M = \left(k \xrightarrow{1} k \right), \quad S(1) = (k \longrightarrow 0).$$

From direct computations of Hom-spaces, one finds:

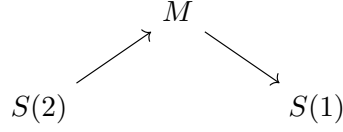
$$\text{Hom}(S(1), M) = 0, \quad \text{Hom}(M, S(2)) = 0, \quad \text{Hom}(S(2), M) \cong k,$$

$$\text{Hom}(S(1), S(2)) = 0, \quad \text{Hom}(M, S(1)) \cong k, \quad \text{Hom}(S(2), S(1)) = 0.$$

Hence there is exactly one non-split short exact sequence with indecomposable end terms:

$$0 \longrightarrow S(2) \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow S(1) \longrightarrow 0.$$

This sequence is an almost split sequence. Therefore the Auslander–Reiten quiver has three vertices, two arrows, and one mesh:



A convenient shorthand notation

It is often useful to encode an indecomposable representation by its dimension vector together with the relative position of the vertices.

Suppose

$$Q_0 = \{1, 2, \dots, n\}, \quad M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha)$$

is an indecomposable representation of Q , and

$$\dim M = (d_1, d_2, \dots, d_n).$$

We depict M by writing the digit i exactly d_i times. Moreover, if there is an arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$ such that the map

$$\varphi_\alpha : M_i \rightarrow M_j$$

is nonzero, then we place the symbol i above the symbol j .

For the quiver $1 \rightarrow 2$, the representation

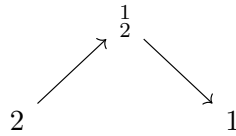
$$M = \left(k \xrightarrow{1} k \right)$$

may be represented symbolically by

$$\frac{1}{2},$$

meaning that both vector spaces are one-dimensional and the arrow carries a nonzero map.

In this notation, the Auslander–Reiten quiver above becomes



Example 2: the quiver $1 \rightarrow 2 \leftarrow 3$

Let

$$Q : \quad 1 \longrightarrow 2 \longleftarrow 3.$$

In this case there are exactly six isomorphism classes of indecomposable representations:

$$S(2) = (0 \longrightarrow k \longleftarrow 0), \quad P(1) = \left(k \xrightarrow{1} k \longleftarrow 0 \right), \quad P(3) = \left(0 \longrightarrow k \xleftarrow{1} k \right),$$

$$I(2) = \left(k \xrightarrow{1} k \xleftarrow{1} k \right), \quad S(1) = (k \longrightarrow 0 \longleftarrow 0), \quad S(3) = (0 \longrightarrow 0 \longleftarrow k).$$

Using the symbolic notation, these are

$$S(2) = 2, \quad P(1) = \frac{1}{2}, \quad P(3) = \frac{3}{2}, \quad I(2) = \frac{13}{2}, \quad S(1) = 1, \quad S(3) = 3.$$

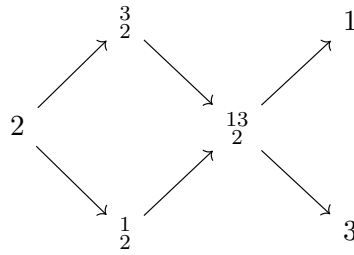
There are three almost split sequences:

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \frac{1}{2} \oplus \frac{3}{2} \longrightarrow \frac{13}{2} \longrightarrow 0,$$

$$0 \longrightarrow \frac{1}{2} \longrightarrow \frac{13}{2} \longrightarrow 3 \longrightarrow 0,$$

$$0 \longrightarrow \frac{3}{2} \longrightarrow \frac{13}{2} \longrightarrow 1 \longrightarrow 0.$$

Consequently, the Auslander–Reiten quiver has the form



Further non-split short exact sequences

In the quiver $1 \rightarrow 2 \leftarrow 3$, besides the almost split sequences above, there are also two further non-split short exact sequences with indecomposable end terms:

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \frac{3}{2} \longrightarrow 3 \longrightarrow 0,$$

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \frac{1}{2} \longrightarrow 1 \longrightarrow 0.$$

These are not themselves almost split sequences, but they may be viewed as being obtained by combining meshes in the Auslander–Reiten quiver.

Conclusion

These examples illustrate the philosophy of Auslander–Reiten theory:

- vertices correspond to indecomposable representations;
- arrows correspond to irreducible morphisms;
- meshes encode almost split sequences.

Thus the Auslander–Reiten quiver provides a compact and highly structured picture of the category $\text{Rep } Q$.